

Sample Writing answers

C21



Additional sample Writing answers
in Resource Bank

TEST 1, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 5.5** score.

The graph shows how changes are occupations in four different kind of jobs in the US from 1960 to 2020.

In 1960, the number of Manufacturing is the highest in these four sectors, 15 millions, and the second highest is Retail and Agriculture as a same number (5 million). I can see the hugh gap between highest number of occupations and second's in 1960. Moreover, Healthcare is lowest number at approximately 2.5 million.

Firstly, the number of healthcare increace dramatically rather than the other three sectors. People who work as a healthcare had grown more than six times in 60 years, which is the highest number in 2020 with Retail sector. Furthermore, the number of Retail is also great rise.

Manufacturing was most common jobs in 1960, however these declined from 15 million to 13 million in 2020.

In addition, Agriculture was third highest in 1960 and had decreased 6 million to 2 million, which is the lowest in 2020.

To sum up, it can be seen that the economy in the US changed significantly in 60 years from 1960 to 2020, and at the same time occupations had been altered.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response is a good attempt at the task. It does include the main information in the line chart but there are some details missing, for example, manufacturing [declined from 15 million to 13 million] with no mention of the peak in 1980 at 20 million.

There is an attempt at an overview in the final paragraph, [To sum up, it can be seen that the economy in the US changed significantly in 60 years from 1960 to 2020, and at the same time occupations had been altered.] However, this is too generic. An overview needs to summarise the main changes that have occurred.

Ideas are presented coherently. There are some nice examples of cohesive devices [Moreover | Firstly | In addition | To sum up] but some overuse [Furthermore | however].

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Some effective vocabulary is used [*second highest* | *approximately* | *dramatically* | *common* | *significantly* | *altered*] but, generally, the lapses in word choice have a negative impact on the score, [*healthcare* / jobs in healthcare | *as a healthcare* / as a healthcare assistant]. Spelling is generally good, with a sprinkle of errors [*hugh* / *huge*] that do not impede understanding. Grammatical structures are not well controlled, with frequent errors, for example, in verb tenses [*how changes are occupations* / changes in occupations | *increase* / increased], countable forms [*four different kind of* / kinds of | *Manufacturing was most common jobs* / Manufacturing jobs were the most common / Manufacturing was most common] and articles [*as a same number* / as the same number].

To achieve a higher score, the candidate should include an overview that summarises the main changes, and demonstrate a greater level of accuracy in vocabulary and grammar.

Example overview

To sum up, it can be seen that the economy in the US changed significantly in 60 years, with jobs in manufacturing starting out as the highest, but being overtaken by the rising numbers in the retail and healthcare sectors by the end, and a downward trend in the numbers of jobs in the agricultural sector.

TEST 1, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7** score.

Firstly, tall apartment blocks economize land area since it makes use of its vertical space compared to multiple residential areas which waste a major portion of area, multiple apartments can squeeze in more homes at each floor. Besides, heavily populated cities are rife with locals and expatriates seeking a place to live in a while they go about their business there. By utilising the apartment's geometrical structure, more homes can be provided for them at a cheaper cost.

Moreover, apartment blocks usually offer homes at a price lower than the ones set for onland homes. Bungalows, semi-detached, double story houses and others would usually be a pain in the wallet for someone without a stable or sufficient income, much like those who are new to the city. By building more apartments, more affordable housing can be accessed by many layers of the society. To paint a picture, we can visualize an example of a rookie worker at a major firm in a big city like Kuala Lumpur. He or she might not be planning to permanently reside there and raise a family but they definitely have the option of a stable house to return to at the end of a day's work. For families, they definitely can benefit the most as they do not have to pay a throat-choking price while still juggling the cost of raising children and dealing with bills and taxes.

In conclusion, governments should implement an urban-planning scheme which involve building more tall apartment blocks in large cities. In doing so, the percentage of homelessness may decrease largely. Not only that, the productivity of the city will improve and boost the country's overall economy. Homes are crucial for a harmonious and safe community as well as healing one's mental health. Although there may be other mechanisms in place to achieve this common goal, I still stand firm with my reasons.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is a strong response overall. The first part addresses the benefits of tall apartment blocks, and includes the efficient use of 'vertical space' to fit in more homes, the benefits of 'geometrical structure' providing cheaper costs. The writer states that homes in apartments are usually more affordable and gives examples of [rookie workers] and [families] in Kuala Lumpur, having a safe place to return to [at the end of a day's work].

There is no mention of the advantages of other types of homes, but in this kind of question, it does not need to be presented. In the conclusion, the writer states that governments should build these kinds of tall apartment blocks, to decrease homelessness, increase the economy, and benefit community mental health.

Progression is logical. Linking expressions are appropriate [Firstly | Besides | By... | Moreover | To paint a picture] with some good examples of reference [the ones | those who are | which] and paragraphing is helpful.

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Vocabulary use is strong with some precise meanings and effective collocation [*squeeze in* | *rife with* | *stable or sufficient income* | *implement* | *boost* | *harmonious* | *healing one's mental health* | *mechanisms in place* | *common goal*] . There are some small slips in lexis [*onland homes* | *throat-choking price*] although the meaning is clear. Sentences are varied and contain complex structures. There are multi-clause sentences with a range of structures, including modal verbs [*might* | *can* | *should*], but a few errors remain.

Overall, this is a good response. To achieve a higher score, the candidate should include a few more ideas around the 'best way' to provide enough homes. Comparing the 'tall apartment blocks' to other solutions for providing enough homes would be beneficial.

TEST 2, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 6** score.

The maps display how the café changes after it was redeveloped. It compares how as it is now and as it is before redesign.

First of all before the modifications, we can see that there was a kitchen and a serving area at the top left hand corner of the café. Then, in the midle, there was the seatting area, and just above, two staff dining rooms. After that, just at the bottom of the entrance, there was bin and there were the toilets. However we can see that now, the bins have been changed into recycling bins. In addition, the staff dining rooms have been replaced with a take away food and a coffee bar. Although the seating area hasn't been modificated, on the left side, a salad bar has been added. At the top left-hand corner, the kitchen remains the same, while the serving area has been transformed into hot meals. Finally, a outdoor seating area and a barbecue have been constructed at the bottom of the café.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response addresses all of the changes illustrated in the college café plans. The writer describes how the café looked before the modifications, then moves on to the present day map. There is no overview, or summary of the information, but all main changes have been captured.

Information is generally arranged coherently. The first paragraph is an introduction, and the second contains the rest of the comparison. There is evidence of linking expressions [*First of all* | *Then* | *After that* | *Although*], however, there is a lack of reference, resulting in repetition [*as it is*].

Vocabulary is generally good [*modifications* | *replaced with* | *transformed into*] but errors remain [*redesign* / redesign | *midle* / middle | *seating* / seating | *modificated* / modified].

Grammatical range is mixed. There are examples of complex sentence forms, but there is frequent repetition of verb forms e.g passive structures [*have been changed* | *have been replaced* | *hasn't been modificated* | *has been added*] which means the range is limited and precludes a higher score.

To improve the score, an overview that summarises the main changes should be added. It would also be beneficial to show greater accuracy in vocabulary and a wider range of grammatical structures.

Example overview

We can see that the overall shape of the college café has remained the same, with some additions, for example, outdoor areas have been added, the staff areas have been removed and the centralised serving area is now distributed to various locations in the café.

TEST 2, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7** score.

People have differing views about the significance of the theatres and cinemas in the present age of technology. While some argue that there are no need for theatres and cinemas when it is possible to have access to online version of everything, in my opinion, that facilities are still of paramount importance for both people and economics.

On the one hand, people today are able to watch any content they want through Internet without spending a lot of time and money

Firstly, using electronic devise and social platforms makes it possible for users to watch any movies or films at any time they want. Shows and films are put at a certain time in cinemas, theatres which is not suitable for everyone. But if people use internet they can ensure the flexibility. Secondly, prices that have to be paid to enter cinemas and theatres are not affordable for many people However, through using the Internet, to watch a movie or film can be much cheaper

On the other hand, I, however argue that theatres and cinemas still have their significant part in terms of environment and financial benefits. For example, cinemas are provided with very big screens which can make people feel themselves inside the movie and in theatres watchers would enjoy the shows and and performances done by real actors, which is impossible to do in computers and mobile phone screens. On top of this, public theatres can bring the money that can be spent on public needs New roads and other facilities can be erected for public use with the financial funds taken from those cinemas, theatres.

In conclusion, theatres and cinemas can be refered as non-useful places due to the development s in modern technologies but I believe that the use of them would bring a lot of advantages to bot people and society

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is a strong response, with a series of ideas for each part, presented effectively. It starts with a note that different countries have different patterns and the writer's position is clear in the first paragraph [*facilities are still of paramount importance*]. The first half captures the benefits of watching performances and movies online; it saves time and money, people can watch at any time of day, with flexibility. Paragraph 4 presents the economic and cultural benefits, the big screen makes people feel more included in the experience, real live actors, who can so dome things that computers cannot, public money can be raised from get togethers for specific needs. The candidate concludes that some people think that cinemas and theatres are [*non-useful places*] but they believe there could bring a lot of advantages.

Ideas are logically organised, and cohesive devices are varied. Reference is used [*when* | *those*] but with some inaccuracy [*that facilities*]. Some effective linking devices are used [*On the one hand* | *Firstly* | *Secondly* | *On the other hand* | *On top of this*]. However, paragraph 2 is one sentence, and should be combined with paragraph 3 for a more logical progression.

Vocabulary is a strength, with frequent high-level items and some skilful collocation [*of paramount importance* | *differing views* | *watch any content*] although, some errors remain [*devise* / *device*] and there are some examples of less precise language [*make people feel themselves inside the movie* | *watchers* / *audiences* | *non-useful places*].

Grammatical structures are also varied and show some flexibility and some multi-clause sentences, including modal verbs and [*if*] clauses. However, most sentences are not error-free, as there are slips with articles, prepositions [*in computers* / *on computers*], other simple structures [*is* | *are*] and some missing punctuation.

To achieve a higher score, the candidate could make the paragraphing more consistent, and aim for a greater degree of accuracy in vocabulary and grammatical structures.

TEST 3, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 5.5** score.

How is the process for rain-shadow appears in deserts the image below is the explanation about the formation of rain-shadow in this desert in specific

The first that i can see is the thousand of kilometers between the sea and the inland behind the mountains. This is important because the process have a lot of steps and the distance gives time to all of them

First of all, the clouds are formed because the winds from the sea arrove to the coast and grow up until the top of mountain while the moist air are rise and cool. Moreover on the top of mountain starts to rains.

Then, the dry air continues over the mountain until the below part. This part saids inland areas finally, in this part when the dry winds founds the inland areas, the rain-shadow desert appears

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response addressed the requirements of the task but, overall, there is a lack of detail.

The first paragraph is an introduction to the diagram. Task 1 Academic tasks require an overview, a summary of the key stages of the process, but this is missing. Paragraph 2 contains some irrelevant information [*This is important because the process have a lot of steps and the distance gives time to all of them*]. The main response comes in paragraphs 3 and 4 and it does include the main features, but there are details missing, such as 'clouds form' 'Windward side' and 'Leeward side'. The irrelevant content and missing details detract from the score for this task.

Information is generally arranged coherently and there are linking expressions [*First of all* | *Moreover* | *Then*] and some referencing within the process [*this desert* | *all of them* | *this part*]. There is some repetition [*The first* | *First of all*] but overall, cohesive devices are used to some good effect.

Vocabulary is generally good and appropriate for the task [*appears* | *explanation*], the meaning is clear but there are errors [*arrove* / *arrive* | *grow up* / *move up* | *said* / *sees*] and a lack of precision [*in specific* / *specifically* | *gives time* | *below part*]. Similarly, the grammatical range is narrow, often inaccurate and repetitive but the writer does attempt multi clause sentences [*while* | *when*] and a modal verb [*can*] so there is some ability. Overall though, grammatical errors are frequent and they do cause some difficulty in understanding.

To achieve a higher score, an overview, which summarises the main stages of the process should be presented.

Example overview

This process of forming a rain-shadow desert includes three main stages. Firstly, the wind pushes moist air up from the sea, then rain clouds form and rain falls over the mountains, finally, dry air reaches the inland areas, to make the desert.

TEST 3, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7.5** score.

As the number of educated people is continually growing, universities attempt to make the process of studying (and its result) as efficient as possible. Among the ideas to improve the conditions of students are the thoughts that all undergraduate courses should include a period of time spent studying abroad or doing a work placement.

A number of higher education establishments have already implemented these ideas into life. However, this is the advantage of developed countries, whose economy allows them spend money on this aspect.

Unfortunately, Ukraine is not among their number. Yet.

Weighing up the pluses and minuses of such strategies one can't but mention that advantages prevail. Firstly, going abroad, a student gets the opportunity to compare the approaches and levels of education. Moreover, undergraduates, who are still polishing their skills, have the chance to practice them in the completely new environment and probably see new horizons of their future career. In addition to the above mentioned reasons, let us consider the fact of cultural enrichment.

What concerns doing a work placement most of us will agree with the opinion, that theory and practice are two polar sides of any job. The possibility to try yourself in several work positions or even fields gives mostly advantages, allowing students to fit themselves into the real profession, opposing to those which are so wonderfully depicted in films and books. Moreover, a lot of people spend their whole life doing a job they do not really enjoy. So, why spend time on something you are not that good at?

There are definitely the drawbacks of such ideas, one of them being economical inability of education system to provide such courses for undergraduates in ALL universities. However, the fact that developed countries are already moving forward in that direction gives us hope that in short or long time this strategy will become wide spread and even will be taken by us as granted. After all, what to invest money in if not in young people, the future of humanity.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is a strong, detailed and well-developed response. Ideas are appropriate and the position is presented at the beginning of the 4th paragraph [advantages prevail]. The first three paragraphs act as the introduction. Paragraph 4 addresses the advantages of time spent studying abroad (which include comparing approaches and levels of education, practising skills in a new environment, seeing new horizons for future careers and cultural enrichment). Paragraph 5 addresses the advantages of doing a work placement (which include trying work positions

and fitting into real professions). The final paragraph presents the drawbacks, although the main disadvantage mentioned is the inability of all universities to afford these initiatives, which is not a drawback of the initiatives themselves, but in the ability to run them.

Some of paragraph 5 is less relevant to the question [*why spend time on something you are not that good at?*]. To improve this response, there could be more relevant detail on the advantages of work placements and, possibly, mention of 'disadvantages' of studying abroad and work placements themselves.

The ideas presented are organised logically and the six paragraphs support overall coherence. Although paragraph 3 is only one sentence, so not a standard paragraph but this can be seen as a stylistic variant, to make the point more clearly. Cohesion is used well throughout, and the message can be followed with ease.

Vocabulary is used well, with flexibility and precision [*polishing their skills* | *new horizons* | *moving forward in that direction* | *future of humanity*], with mostly accurate spelling and only a few errors in word choice [*implemented these ideas into life* | *polar sides* | *taken as granted* / *taken for granted*]. Similarly, the range of grammatical structures is wide. There are frequent multi-clause sentences and error-free sentences are frequent.

This is a good, articulate response. There are a few small lapses in vocabulary and grammatical structures, and more could be added on the advantages of work placements, to score even more highly.

TEST 4, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 6** score.

In this chart, we can see a representation of categories and satisfaction of library users, the first feature that we pay attention is the users majority take part of full-time undergraduate and full-time post-graduate, such as they probably are the biggest data of library satisfaction, since very satisfied until not satisfied, also post-graduate students would need more special materials to hardest researchs and learning method, Even thought undergraduates students, fresh or veteran, are o their initial academic career, both categories look satisfied with the library between another may, as the fact they use it more than once during a day.

On the other hand, academic staff is the lowest data categorie that use the library, with a percentage of 17%, the reason beyond this effect is because the staffs must to focus on their work, so they probably use the library on their free-time, however, distance learning students have a 8% percentage, both categories have a 1% difference percentage, which explain they took a little part of satisfaction research, distance learning have a low percentage because the fact they also access online materials.

Finally, part-time postgraduate students are the medium date, with a 16% percentage. where they would use the libraray to classroom researchs or homeworks.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is generally a good response, there is an introduction at the start, and an attempt at an overview [...the users majority take part of full-time undergraduate and full-time post-graduate, such as they probably are the biggest data of library satisfaction]. To improve the overview, there should be a summary across both charts. Key data from the pie chart is presented quite well but the 'Library user satisfaction' data is not sufficiently covered. There are also examples of irrelevant information [would need more special materials | use it more than once during a day | use the library on their free-time] which can detract from task achievement.

Ideas are mostly arranged logically. There are some nice linking expressions [since | also | so | Finally | On the other hand] with some slips [Even thought / Even though], and some good examples of reference [their | they].

Vocabulary is mainly appropriate and spelling is generally well managed [representation | pay attention]; some errors remain but don't affect understanding. Grammatical structures are mixed, but there are multi clause sentences and examples of a range of structures, including modal verbs used correctly [would need], and with some errors [must to focus].

This response could be improved by including an overview that covers both charts (so, including the 'Library user satisfaction' table,) and eliminating the irrelevant content. A wider range of vocabulary and grammatical structure would also help improve the score.

Example overview

Overall, the survey of library users at this university shows that full time students were by far the largest user group, with Academic staff in a minority. We also see that library users were 'very satisfied' the majority of the time, and were especially pleased with the helpfulness of staff but least satisfied with the wi-fi and access to journals.

TEST 4, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7.5** score.

Nowadays individuals are arguing that primary schools pay a lot of attention to the formal methods of learning. I partially agree with this point of view, however I think play is extremely crucial in the classroom full of primary students.

To begin with, formal learning plays an important role, since it teaches the student about being disciplined and respectful to everyone. Discipline and respect are two most important skills we need in our life that schools teaches us in a way of formal learning. Getting into details, these skills make people succeed in their lives. If we look at the example of successful people today they all have these two qualities in common. Moreover formal learning helps us to test the ability of a student by conducting an exam in a formal way, which shows us how much has a student learnt and how much is the student capable of doing.

On the other hand, I believe that too formal education is not the best way of learning. Considering the stage of the life in which primary students belong, we need to realize that fun is a crucial part of it. Being extremely formal blocks that fun from a student's life. So instead of schools being strict about formal ways of learning they should promote fun methods of teaching. For example, mind games other other video games, colours, paints and other activities will also teach student but in a enjoyable way. These activities will also promote the important skills such as social skills, creative skills and other beneficial skills we need in our daily lives. Furthermore, if we consider it deeply it will also prevent boredom and will motivate the student to have a passion for lifelong learning. last but not the least, play in the primary classroom has a huge importance on it's own. which gives the student this freedom to enjoy learning.

In conclusion, formal learning has it's importance till some extent but sometimes it is a necessity to be informal. And schools should be focused at both of the methods of learning

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is an excellent response that presents a range of relevant ideas. The writer sets out their position in the opening paragraph, and addresses both parts of the question. Paragraph 2 presents the importance of formal learning: it teaches discipline and respect, it allows people to take exams to show how much they have learned and are capable of. Paragraph 3 goes on to present the importance of play: being too formal blocks fun, schools should promote 'fun' methods of teaching, they make suggestions of types of games and activities that could be used to teach in an enjoyable way, prevent boredom, and instil a love for lifelong learning. The conclusion brings the response to an end, but is quite general. It is appropriate, but could be more focused.

Ideas are presented logically. A range of good linking expressions are used [*To begin with* | *Moreover* | *On the other hand* | *Furthermore*]. However, almost every sentence begins with a linking device which makes it quite mechanical. Generally, reference and cohesion within sentences is well managed [*which* | *it*]. A reduction in the number of linking devices that come at the start of sentences would make it less formulaic.

Vocabulary is well managed, with a good range of higher-level items, including collocation [*pay...attention* | *capable of doing* | *a crucial part of*]. There are occasional errors [*till* / *to* | *focused at* / *focused on*] that detract from the highest scores. Grammatical structures are well presented, with a range of complex structures, including multi clause sentences. A few errors do remain.

Overall, this is a very strong and articulate response. To achieve a higher score, the candidate could provide a conclusion that refers directly to the question, and avoid starting each sentence with a linking expression.